



Manush Shah, Diya Chitale crowned national TT champions



Manush Shah and Diya Chitale claimed the titles after defeating Payas Jain and top seed Sreeja Akula, respectively, in the singles finals of the 86th Senior National Table Tennis Championship, which concluded at the Pandit Dindayal Upadhyay Indoor Stadium in Surat.

Manush, the bespectacled southpaw from Vadodara, continued his dominant form to overcome Payas in five games during the best-of-seven final.

An hour earlier, Diya, from Mumbai, staged a remarkable comeback after trailing 2-0 against the favourite Sreeja — India's top-ranked international paddler — and won a thrilling women's final that became the longest match of the day. Diya's singles victory secured her a double crown, having already claimed the doubles title with her partner a day earlier.

Both Manush and Diya received Rs. 3.20 lakh each as prize money. However, it was the glittering trophy that thrilled them the most. Having previously been crowned sub-junior, junior, and youth national champions, both were overjoyed to finally claim the trophy they had coveted for a decade.

AMOL KARHADKAR

INDIAN PLAYGROUND

SPORTOON



1 Nitin Kumar Sinha, the second seed from Kolkata, stunned top-seeded J. Vishnu Vardhan 6-3, 6-4 to claim the men's singles title at the Naushad Mather Memorial AITA National-ranking tennis tournament at the Regional Sports Centre in Kochi. Meanwhile, Pune's top-seeded Pooja Ingale had a much easier time in the women's final, defeating third-seeded Laxmi Siri Dandu 6-4, 6-1. KTA patrons Noordin Mather and Sunayini Naushad Mather presented the prizes.

2 Billiards stalwart Sourav Kothari produced two superb century breaks during the final as he defeated multiple world champion Pankaj Advani 4-2 to claim the title at the National Billiards & Snooker Championship in Indore. Kothari, a former world billiards champion and currently ranked No. 2 in the International Billiards and Snooker Federation (IBSF), won 150-31, 30-154, 9-151, 150-25, 150-90, and 152-147 in a contest where Advani fought until the very end.

STAN RAYAN

TEAM SPORTSTAR